Delhi and latterly in Bengaluru.

If you look back at all this cricket, it *can* start to seem like a treadmill. However, the important point is that I have never looked back. I have always looked resolutely forward, keeping my focus on the next innings, the next match, the next challenge; in my mind, the next task is the only task that ever matters.

Some sports people may be able to master the so-called professional arts of pacing yourself through a long season, preserving energy, even going through the motions at stages, but I have never even located such gears. For me, it's always been full-steam ahead.

The day I lose that boyish enthusiasm for the game will be the day I stop playing. It has not happened yet, and I hope it doesn't happen for a while, but there will be no escape when that day dawns. If I no longer feel engaged and excited by the challenge, there will be no pragmatic decision to keep going. That day may come suddenly, without warning.

For the past 12 years, living the life of an international cricketer has never felt to me like living on a treadmill. On the contrary, it has felt like a wonderful adventure of great days and tough days, of huge challenges and extraordinary experiences. It has felt like a magic carpet ride.

2009

If we believed the Test match victories in Perth and Melbourne at the end of 2008, securing the series win in Australia, would herald a new era of world dominance, we were quickly disappointed. In all my time with the Proteas, we have always competed well against the Australians and have enjoyed a few notable triumphs, but we have never managed to dominate them for a sustained period of time. As a country, as a team, the Aussies always hang in there and always bounce back.

So they regrouped and won the third Test in Sydney and both T20 internationals. We regained some form to secure a 4–1 victory in the ODI series